VPN access at Northgate University

The Northgate VPN lets students, staff and faculty reach campus-only services such as the library databases, departmental file shares and lab machines from off campus. This article explains who is entitled to the VPN, what has to be in place for a connection to work, how to check your access in the account portal, and what the access error codes mean.

Who can use the VPN

Role	VPN access
Student	Included while enrolled
Staff	Included while employed
Faculty	Included while appointed
Guest	Not included. Guests use the visitor Wi-Fi and the public library catalogue.

What a working connection needs

Three things must all be true:

Requirement	Where to check
Your account is **active** (not suspended)	Account portal > **My account** > **Status**
Your role is **entitled** to the VPN	Account portal > **My account** > **Role**
Your account is in the **VPN access group**	Account portal > **Access** > **VPN group** shows *Synced*

The VPN access group is managed by IT. Your account is added to it automatically when your role entitles you; you cannot add yourself.

Connecting

1. Install the Northgate VPN client from the software portal.
2. Enter `vpn.northgate-u.example` as the server and sign in with your university username and password.
3. Approve the sign-in prompt on your phone.

Finding your user ID

The portal shows a short **user ID** such as `U005` under **My account**. Quote it, not your password, whenever you contact the helpdesk.

Access error codes

Code	Message shown	What it means and what to do
AC-100	*Group not synced*	Your role entitles you to the VPN, but your account is not in the VPN access group. This can happen after a sign-on system change. Contact the IT Helpdesk with your user ID; a specialist can re-sync the group.
AC-200	*Role not entitled to VPN*	Your role (for example guest) does not include the VPN. Ask your sponsoring department about a staff or affiliate account.
AC-300	*Account suspended*	Your account is suspended and cannot sign in anywhere. Contact the Registrar or HR, as the portal directs.

FAQ

My password works for e-mail but the VPN says "access denied". E-mail only needs an active account; the VPN also needs the access group. Check **Access > VPN group**; if it shows AC-100, contact the helpdesk.

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